Glucometer



Category: **Medical, Healthcare & First Aid** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 2 labs

Covers these lab items: Glucometer

What it is used for

A glucometer measures blood glucose using a compatible test strip and a small blood sample. Follow the device instructions and clinical procedures for accurate results, infection prevention, and appropriate result reporting.

Main parts

- Glucometer meter and display
- Compatible glucose test strips
- Lancing device and single-use lancets
- Control solution, if specified
- Battery or power source
- Approved sharps container and cleaning supplies

Before you start

1. Verify the user's identity and explain the test procedure.
2. Wash hands and ensure the user's finger is clean and completely dry.
3. Check the meter, test-strip expiry date, and strip storage condition.
4. Confirm the strips match the meter model and coding requirements, if applicable.
5. Inspect the lancing device and use a new sterile single-use lancet.
6. Prepare gloves, if required by the clinical procedure, and a sharps container.

How to use

1. Switch on the meter according to the manufacturer's instructions.
2. Insert a compatible test strip in the indicated direction.
3. Confirm that the meter is ready for the blood sample.
4. Prepare the lancing device with a new single-use lancet.
5. Use the approved technique to obtain a small blood drop from the fingertip.
6. Apply the blood to the test strip's designated sample area.
7. Wait for the meter to display the result.
8. Read and record the result with the date and time, following clinical procedure.
9. Compare the result with the user's care plan or applicable clinical guidance.
10. Report critical, unexpected, or concerning results to the appropriate healthcare professional promptly.
11. Dispose of the lancet immediately in an approved sharps container.
12. Remove and discard the used strip according to local clinical waste procedures.

3. Clean the meter as directed by the manufacturer and store it safely.

⚠ Safety

- Use a new sterile lancet for every person and every test.
- Never share a lancing device, even if the lancet is changed.
- Follow standard precautions and applicable infection-control procedures.
- Do not use expired, damaged, or improperly stored test strips.
- Do not make medication changes based only on a reading without appropriate clinical guidance.
- Follow the device's instructions for cleaning, quality control, and result interpretation.

Care & storage

- Store the meter and strips within the specified temperature and humidity range.
- Keep the strip container closed and follow its storage instructions.
- Perform control-solution checks when recommended by the manufacturer or clinical procedure.
- Clean and disinfect the meter using only compatible approved products.
- Replace batteries and report faulty readings or equipment problems.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Using expired strips or strips incompatible with the meter.
- Testing with wet or contaminated fingers.
- Reusing lancets or sharing a lancing device.
- Recording the result incorrectly or ignoring an unexpected reading.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.